Communication Styles

We don't just communicate differently. We disagree about what communication is for.

Kneebouncers
Communicate to advance the conversation and get things done.

Barometers
Communicate to respond to and manage the emotions in the room.

Listmakers
Communicate to ensure clarity by seeking and reviewing information.

Doodlers
Communicate to explore concepts, alternatives, and consequences.

Kneebouncers

Kneebouncers view communication as a way to move something forward. Meetings probably aren't their favorite way to spend time, and they're likely to be the first to tune out when a conversation drags on.

HOW THEY COMMUNICATE

- Emphasizes **getting to the point.**
- Tends to **speak quickly** and/or in shorter sentences.
- Has a strong internal sense of **"we're done here."**
- Tends to **"tune out"** once they feel they have the information they need.
- Gets **bored or frustrated** in lengthy meetings and collaborative discussions.

HOW TO WORK WITH THEM

- Keep them **engaged** with targeted questions: "What do you think of that?"
- Show the **value of slowing down** to gather important information before they start a task.
- Set **clear action plans** and expectations.
- Then **get out of the way** and let them work at their preferred fast pace.

Barometers

Barometers are experts at reading the room. They're perceptive about how other people feel, and they use their own communication to make sure everyone on the team feels seen and heard.

HOW THEY COMMUNICATE

- **Chooses words carefully** so as not to upset others or disrupt the mood of the room.
- Seeks **other perspectives** and makes sure everyone has a chance to be heard.
- Uses **harmonizing language** ("we," "our").
- Tries to **explain the behavior** of others.

HOW TO WORK WITH THEM

- Acknowledge their concerns, then **emphasize the broader context** of a decision over individual issues.
- **Use data** to explain your reasoning, shifting the focus from "who" to "how" or "why."
- Respect their perspective, but steer them toward **actionable outcomes.**

Listmakers

Listmakers use communication to organize. They don't want to risk missing anything, so they ask for detail and try to capture everything up front, which can make it hard to separate critical from non-critical information.

HOW THEY COMMUNICATE

- Provides **as much information as possible** to ensure nothing is missed.
- Asks for **specific details** or follows up on missed information.
- Frequently **reviews information** (internally and out loud) to ensure understanding.
- Thrives with **an agenda** and clearly identified action items or next steps.

HOW TO WORK WITH THEM

- **Clearly distinguish** between critical and non-critical information.
- Share agendas and materials **ahead of time** so they can prepare.
- Regularly **recap main points** and action items during discussions.
- Put their organized approach to work **improving the team's record keeping.**

Doodlers

Doodlers are abstract, improvisational thinkers. They're comfortable with ambiguity and unorganized information, and they like to wander a bit as they communicate, often reaching for analogies or asking what others might see as unrelated questions.

HOW THEY COMMUNICATE

- Talks about the **long-term consequences** or hypothetical effects of a decision.
- Explores **alternatives** ("What if we tried this?") while making decisions.
- Speaks in **stories, examples, metaphors,** or analogies.
- May **wander around,** physically and figuratively, while thinking.

HOW TO WORK WITH THEM

- Set **clear goals, deadlines, and deliverables.**
- Guide discussions **toward action,** not hypothetical scenarios.
- Give them **time to process,** but don't let conversations drift into endless abstraction.

NOTES

Central Bank of the Ozarks

Reading the scores: each person's four scores add up to 140, so 35 is an even split. Higher means you lean on that style more.

Kneebouncers
1 + 1 tie top style
Team average **31.6**

Barometers
2 top style
Team average **35.3**

Listmakers
6 top style
Team average **38.3**

Doodlers
2 + 1 tie top style
Team average **34.8**

NAME · TOP STYLE	Kneebouncer	Barometer	Listmaker	Doodler
Blake Will Kneebouncer	**37**	35	35	33
Tatyana Osenniy Kneebouncer / Doodler · **tie**	**36**	35	33	**36**
Kimberly White Barometer	25	**45**	39	31
Diane Homan Barometer	29	**39**	36	36
Mandy Anthes Listmaker	30	31	**44**	35
Steve Gassel Listmaker	29	38	**43**	30
James Patrick Nacy Listmaker	30	33	**42**	35
Amy Sharp Listmaker	30	38	**40**	32
Jamie Clark Listmaker	35	28	**39**	38
Shawn Barbour Listmaker	34	34	**39**	33
Andrew Tasset Doodler	29	33	37	**41**
Joselyn Baldner Doodler	35	35	32	**38**